

- *"Where to go?"*
- *"What to watch?"*
- *"What should I plant?"*



Bridging the **Lifestyle Content Gap**

Connecting trending consumer interests to membership benefits to drive engagement and royalty revenue.

STEP 01



**The Problem
& SCQR Frame**

STEP 02



**Approach
& Findings**

STEP 03



**Strategic
Recommendation**

STEP 04



**Next Steps
& Roadmap**



Final Presentation

Analytics Consulting Project - AARP Content Similarity Analysis

Team 6

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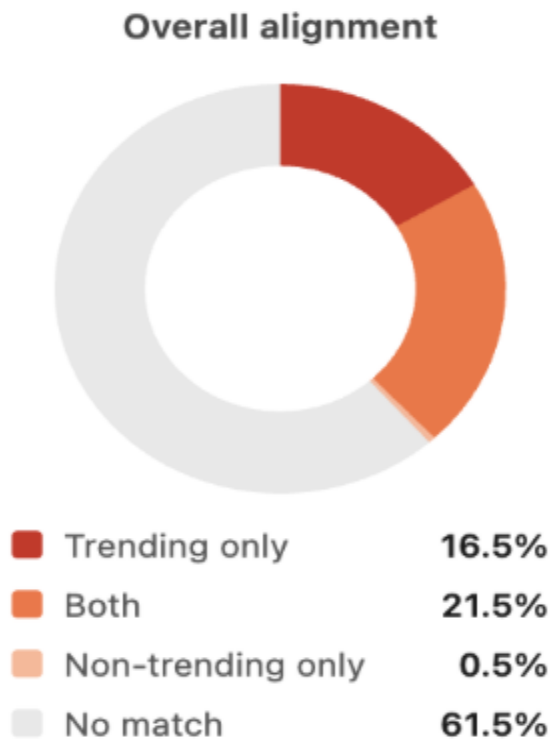
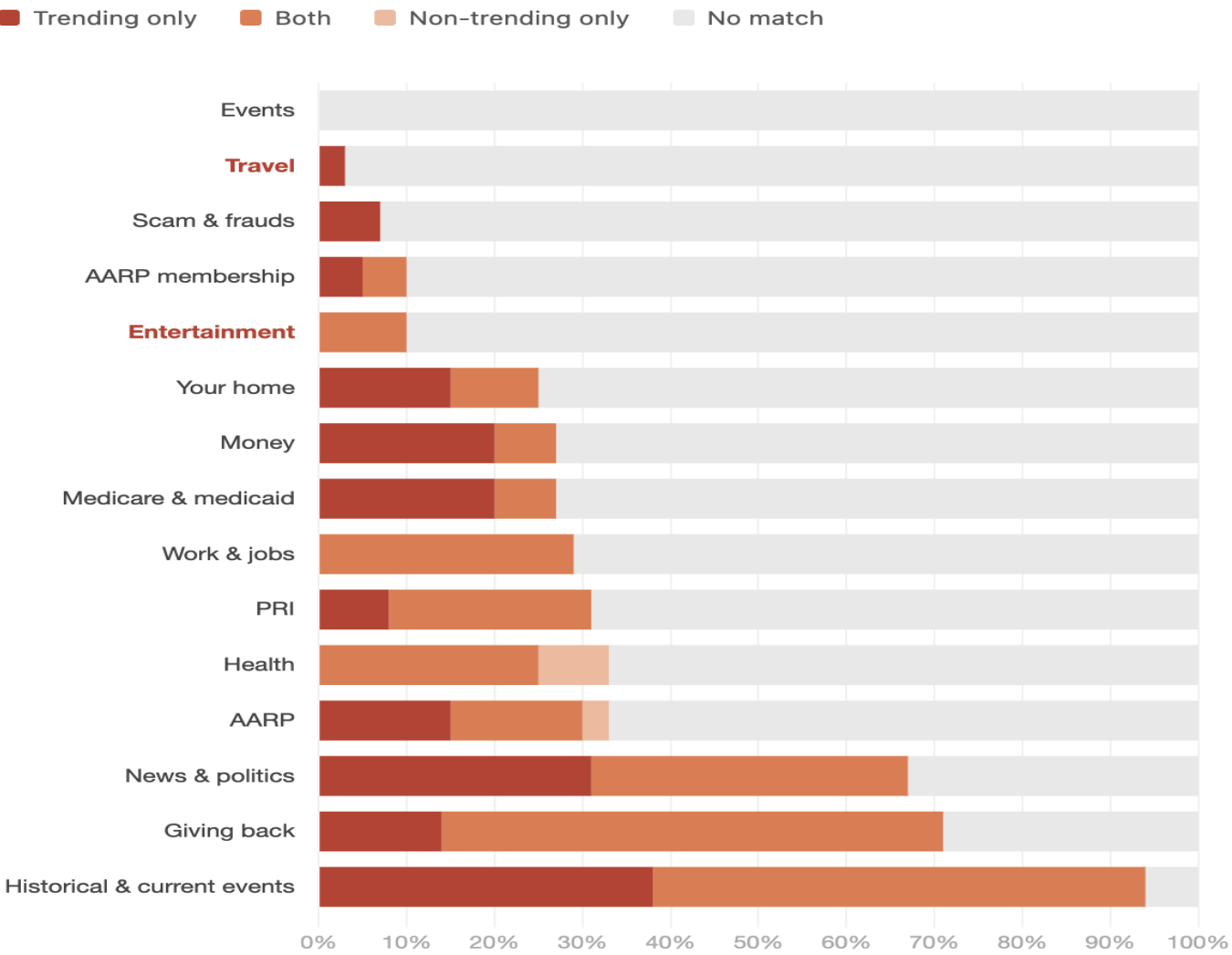
Tong Wu

Yaoyang Wang

Most AARP Content Flies Over the Radar

Entertainment and **Travel**, two of AARP's most-published categories, have almost no alignment with what's trending in national news.

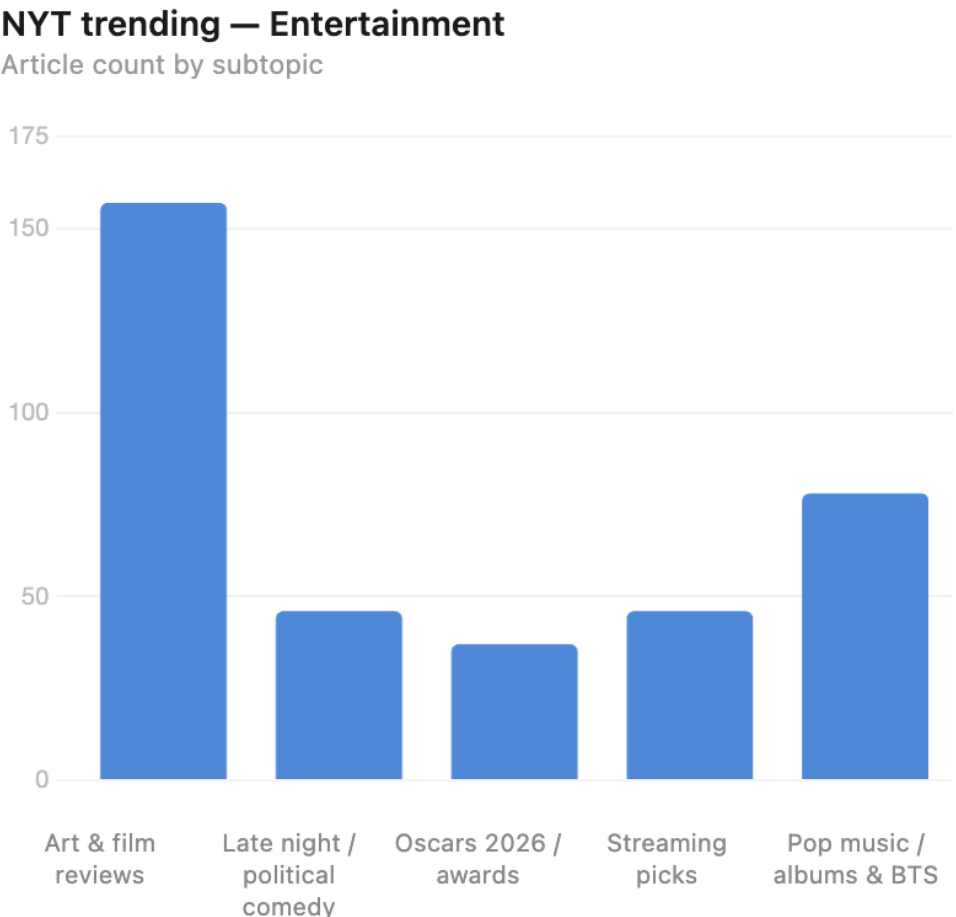
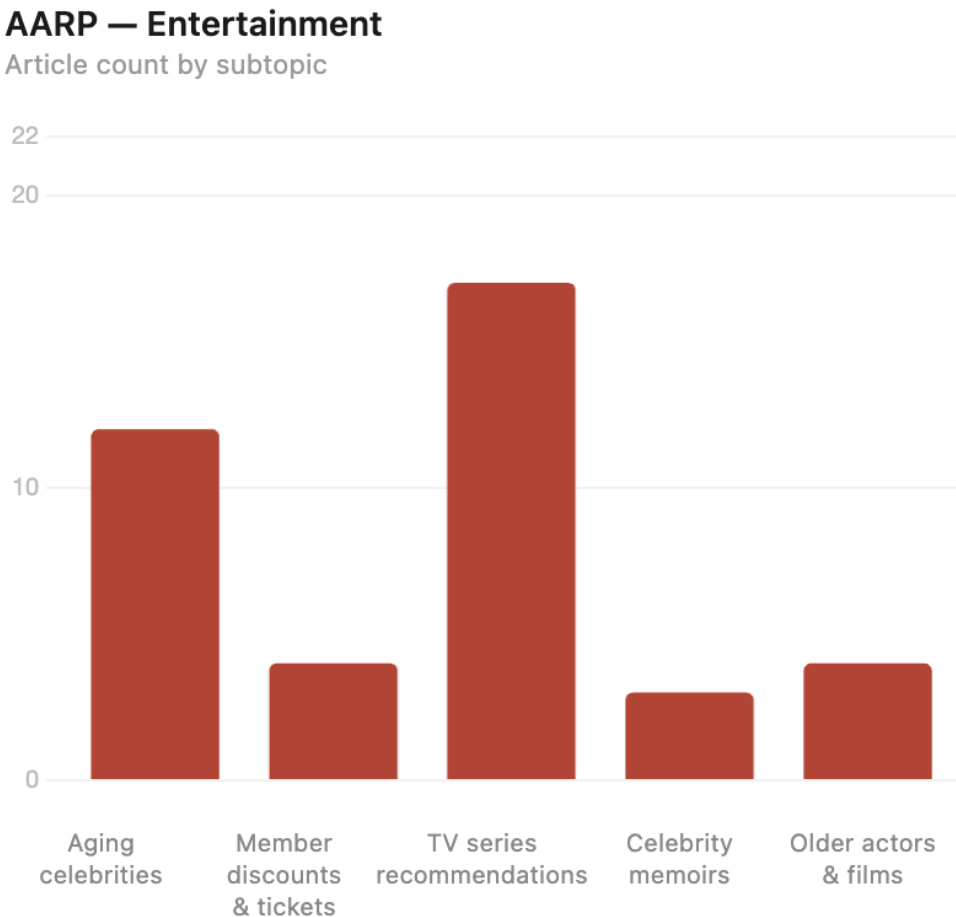
AARP Article Alignment with NYT Topics
Sorted by least aligned first — share of articles by category and match type



Source: "How Does Travel and Entertainment Contribute to Well Being." *Perplexity AI*, perplexity.ai. Accessed 4 May 2026.

AARP Entertainment Covers Aging Stars — NYT Readers Want Reviews, Comedy, and Pop Culture

While AARP focuses on **aging celebrities** and **TV recommendation**, NYT trending entertainment is dominated by **film reviews**, **political comedy**, and **pop music**

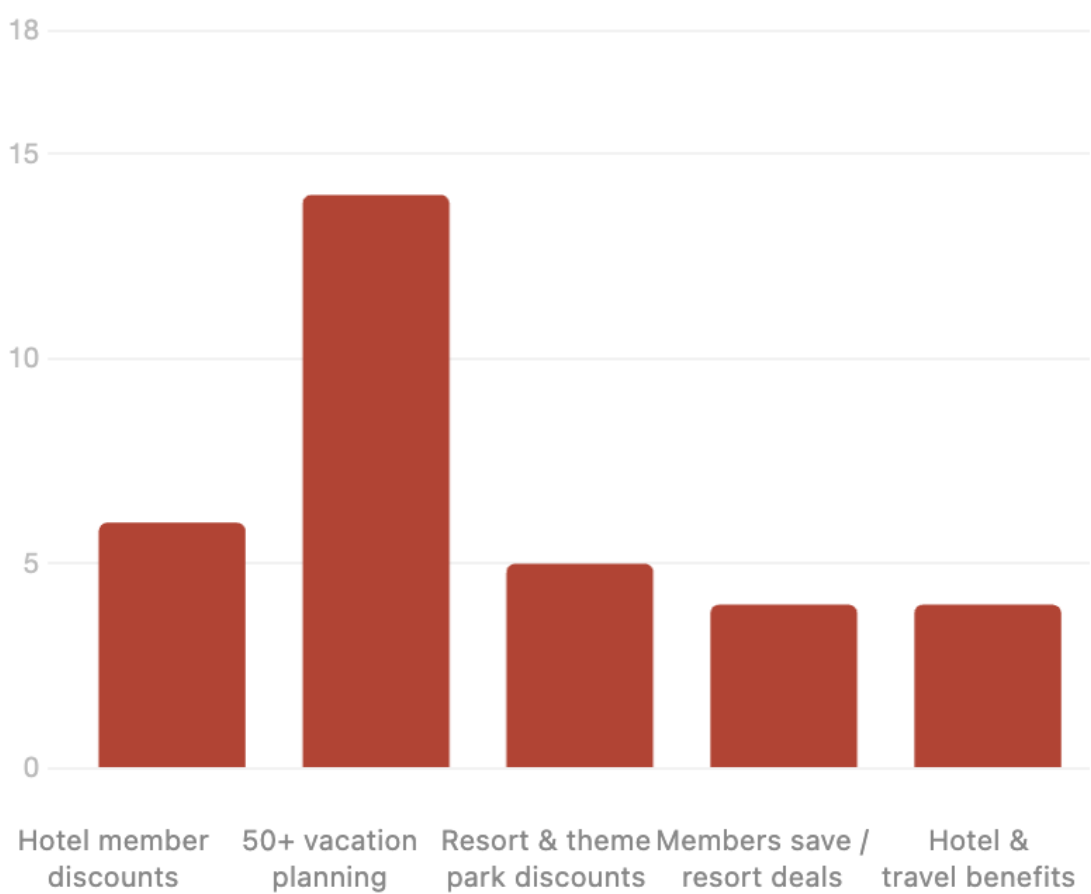


AARP Travel Is About Discounts. NYT Readers Want Destinations.

AARP's travel content is almost entirely focused on **member discounts** and **senior deals**, while NYT trending travel covers **city guides**, **real-world disruptions**, and **aspirational destinations**.

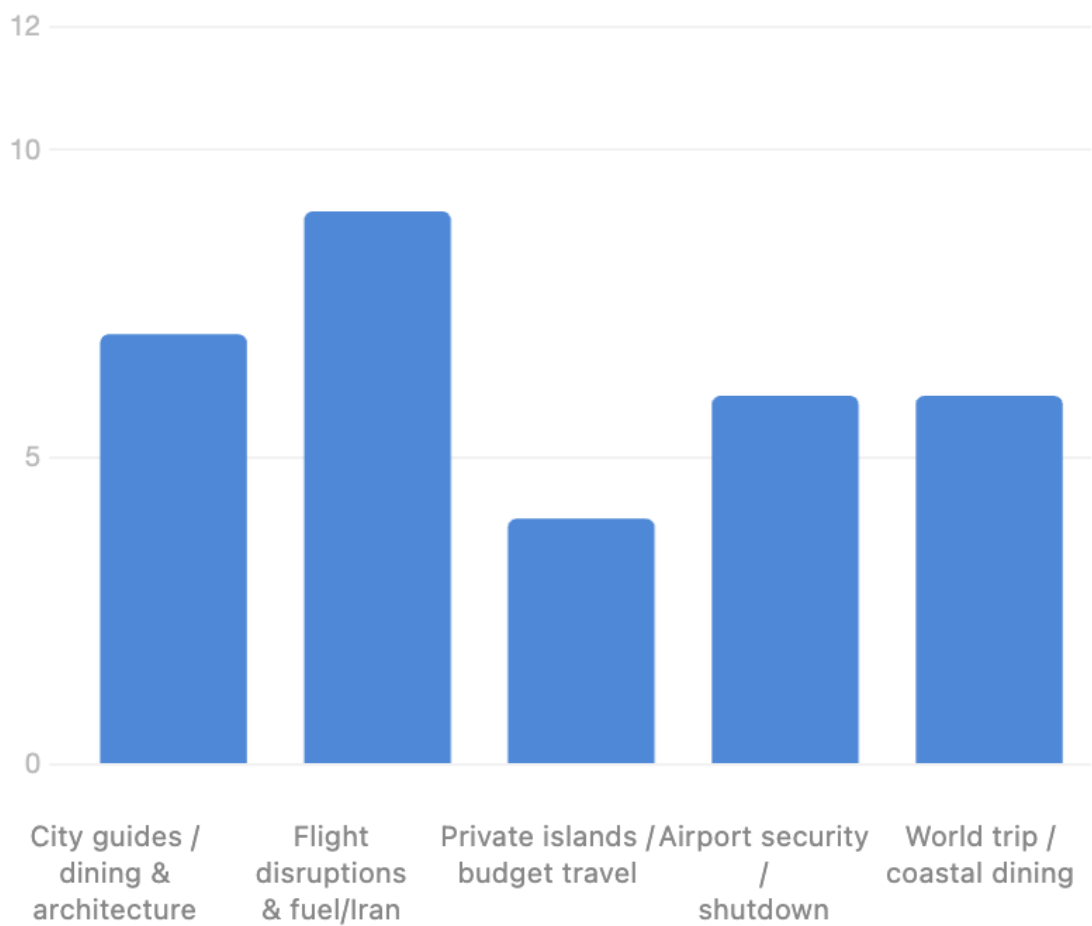
AARP — Travel

Article count by subtopic



NYT trending — Travel

Article count by subtopic



Gardening Is a Shared Topic of AARP and NYT.

Proved audience relevance and content popularity for members 50-65 years old.

Layer 1 · BERTopic

Garden is a Shared Topic

The Semantic Map identifies garden as one of the few topics where NYT and AARP publish at equal volume — confirming it is a mainstream topic, not senior-specific content.

21

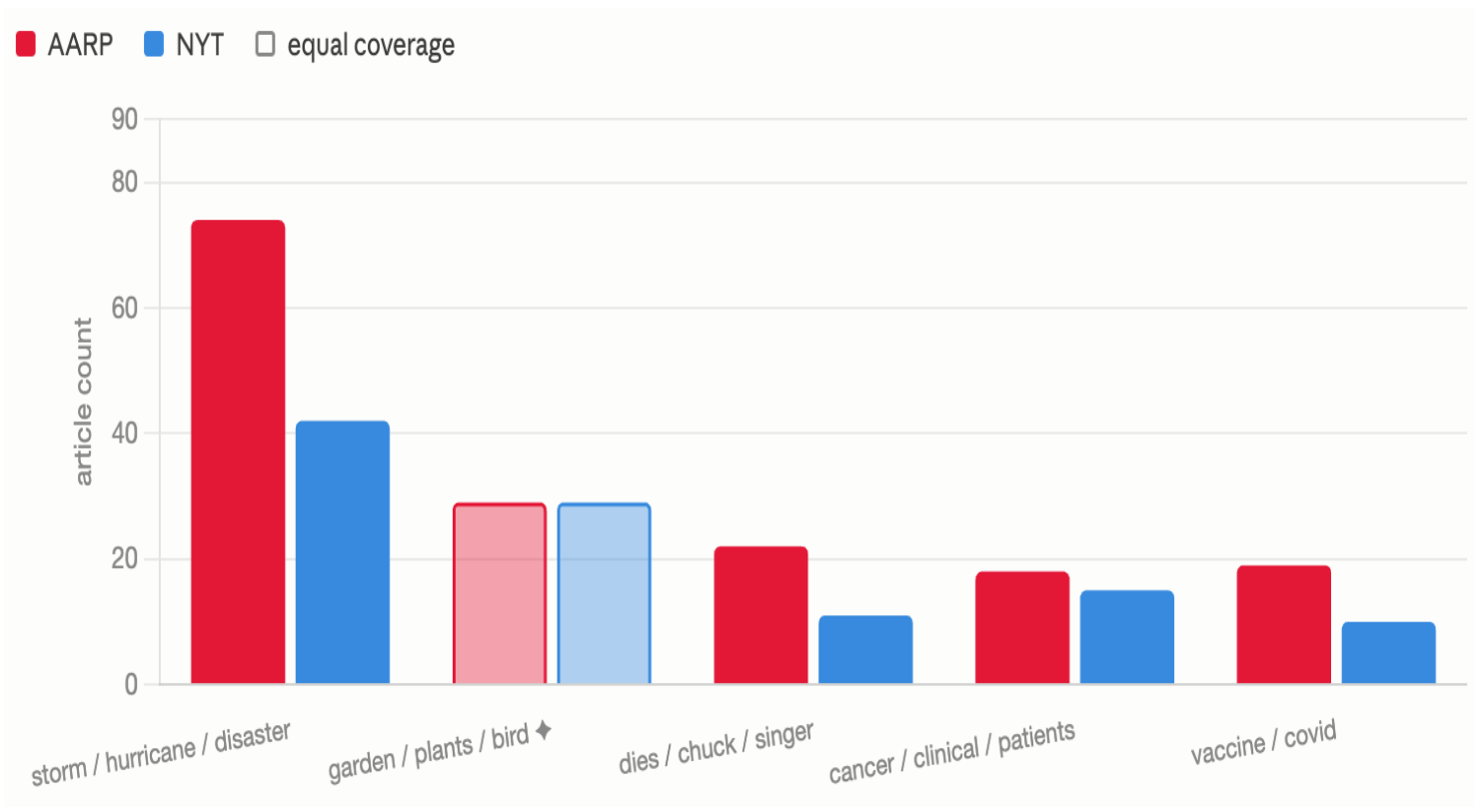
NYT articles

29

AARP articles

50/50

coverage split



Shared topic coverage: AARP vs NYT

Gardening: A Promising Area to Test

Layer 2 · Facebook Most Popular

A 10-Point Gap

Using the trained BERTopic model to classify NYT's 477 most-shared Facebook articles, garden ranks #4 — but AARP's content share tells the opposite story.

11.6%

of Facebook articles

0.7%

of AARP library

#4

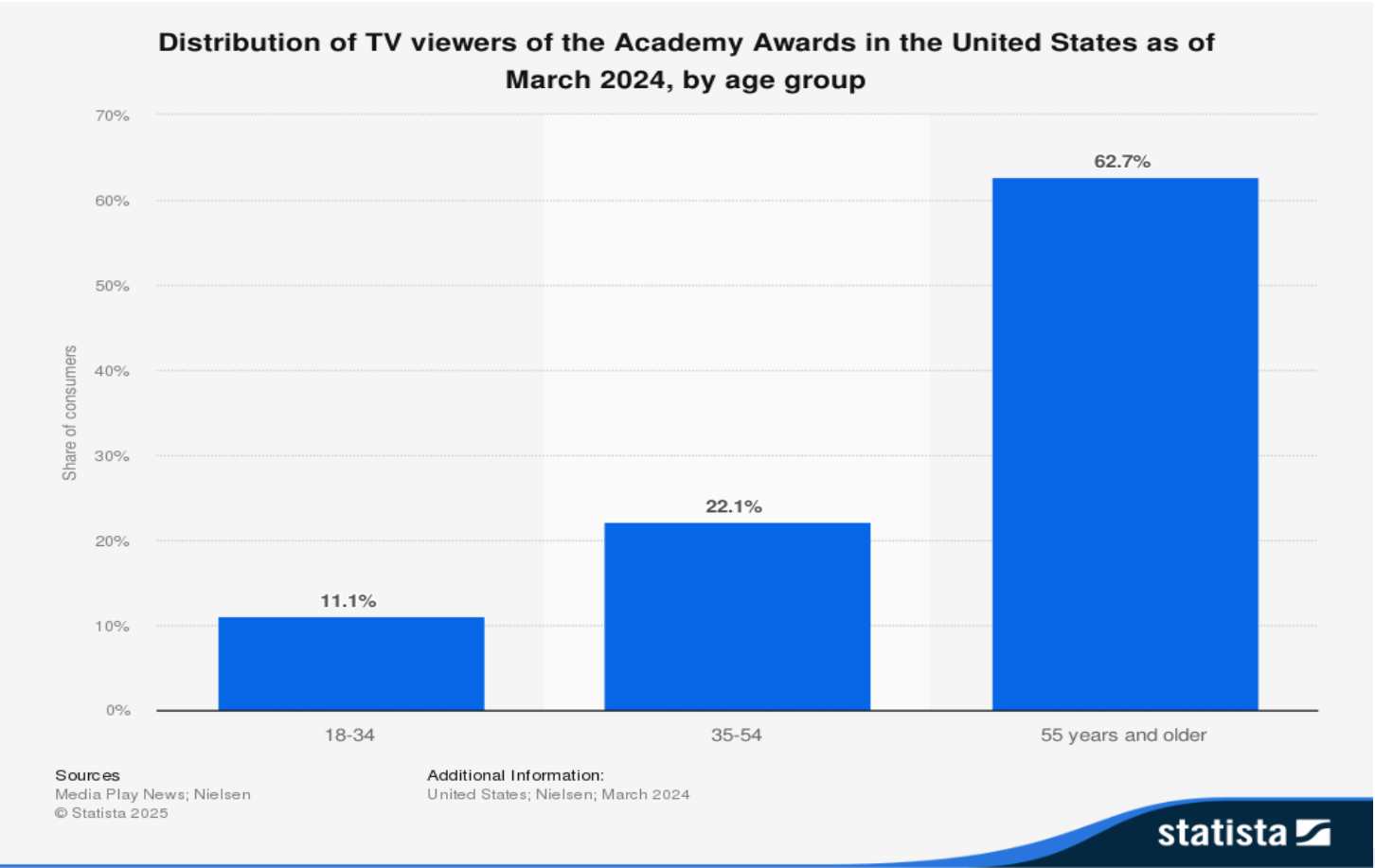
gap rank

Keyword	c-TF-IDF Score
garden	0.153
gardener	0.138
relentless	0.117
relentless gardener	0.108
plants	0.080
new	0.062
gardening	0.061
birds	0.059
vegetable	0.058
know	0.056
fall	0.051

Conclusion

This is not an absence gap — AARP already covers garden. It is an angle and volume gap: garden accounts for 11.6% of what Facebook audiences actually read, but only 0.7% of what AARP publishes. The opportunity is narrative reframing, not starting from scratch.

AARP should broaden entertainment and culture coverage.



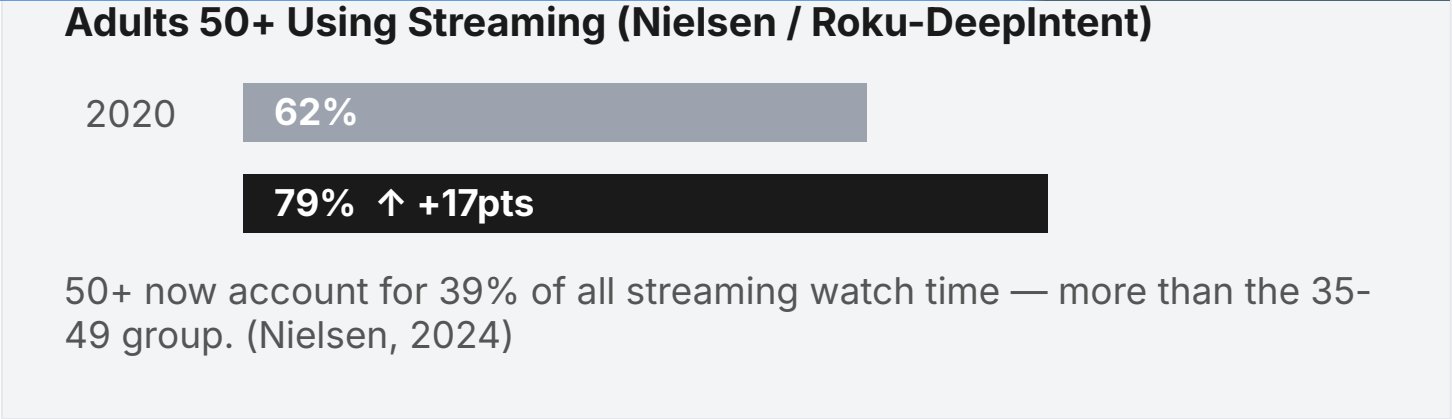
AARP's audience already dominates awards season.

Awards Season

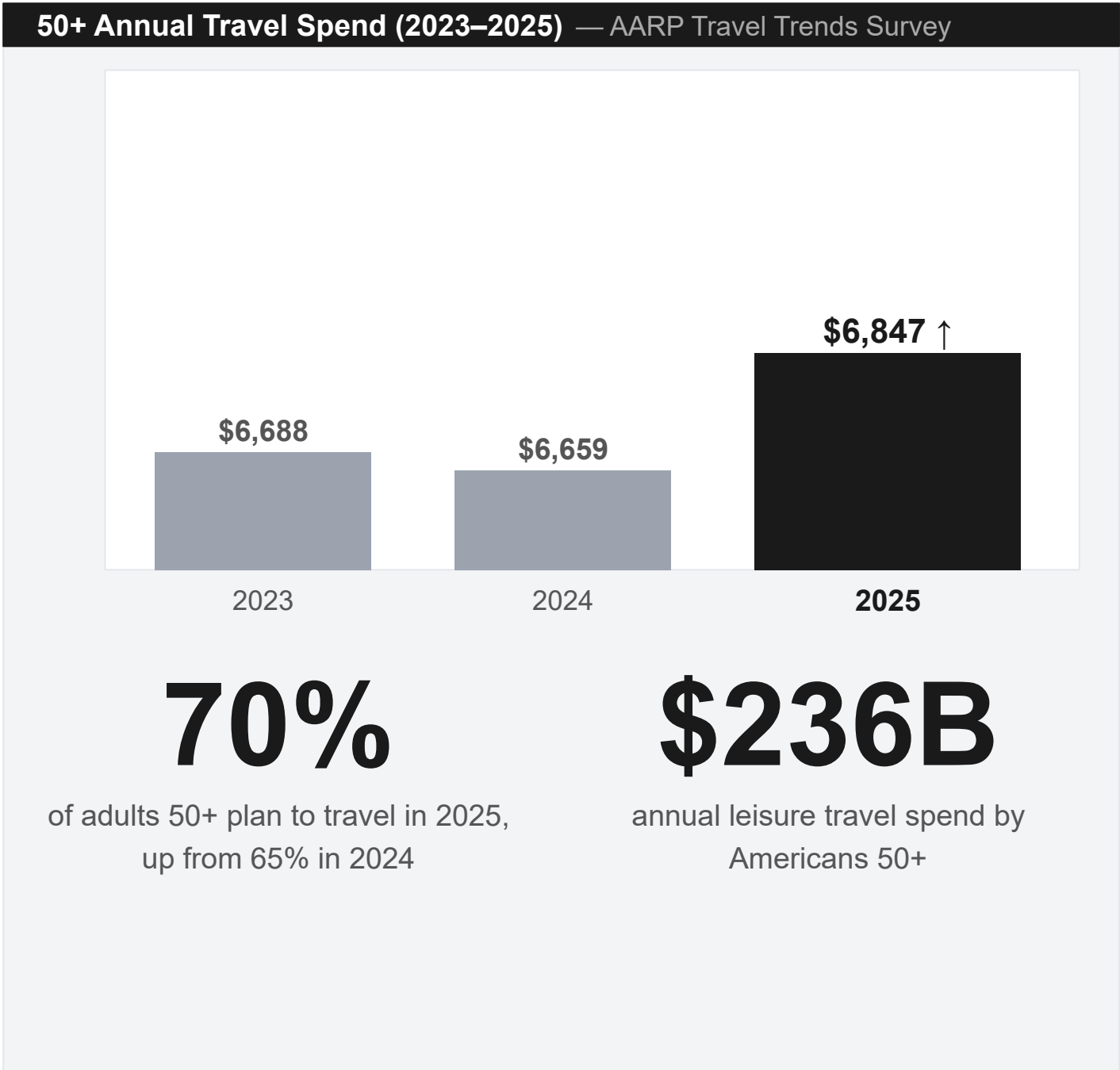
Cover Oscars through the lens of legacy and aging, not just who won. AARP already runs Movies for Grownups. The next step is to connect it to the mainstream conversation.

Streaming

Review shows on their merits. 50+ account for the largest share of streaming time. They don't need age-specific labels.



AARP should reposition travel and dining around experience.



50+ are the top spending travel demographics.

■ **Destination-First Coverage**
50+ travelers spend an average of \$6,847 per year on travel — and 70% plan to travel in 2025, up from 65% last year. AARP should shift from discount tips to aspirational destination coverage: city guides, local experiences, and bucket-list trips.

■ **Match the Reader's Scale**
Americans 50+ collectively spend \$236B on leisure travel annually. This is not a budget demographic. Top international destinations — Italy, Great Britain, France — deserve the same depth of coverage NYT Travel provides.

AARP should test gardening and nature content and integrate it into broader lifestyle coverage.

Persistently High Participation Rates

40%

household gardeners are age 50+, and participation increases with age

Mental Health Benefits for 50+ Audience

80%

of regular gardeners report improved mental health

36%

lower dementia risk in elderly gardeners (Univ. of Western Australia)

20-30%

stress reduction from horticultural therapy (Mather Institute, 2025)

Research-backed mental health benefits AARP's members can own.

■ Move Beyond Planting Tips to Wellness Framing

Frame gardening as a therapeutic practice for dealing with stress, dementia, and sleep issues, connecting it to wellness and care topics central to the 50+ audience.

■ Foster Community Engagement

Use community gardening to promote participation, aging well, and loneliness reduction.

Sources: Mather Institute / Mertz & Smith, *Journals of Gerontology* (2025, n=3,293) — gardening frequency and mental health in adults 55+; wifitalents.com Gardening Statistics compilation 2025 (80% mental health; 36% dementia risk; 20-30% stress reduction); National Gardening Association / Garden Research, *National Gardening Survey 2022 Edition*; WJFI Talents, "Gardening Statistics" compilation

Lifestyle Content is AARP's Most Overlooked Opportunity

- ☐ **Travel #1 (86%), Entertainment #2 (63%)**
Top Discretionary spending priorities for 50+ adults
- ☐ **Existing Member Benefits**
Hotel, Movie, Restaurant, gardening classes.....
- ☐ **Partner Royalties = Core revenue**
Partnerships are valuable
- ☐ **Demand exists**
This Audience is seeking for lifestyle content



**Lifestyle Content =
Activation Layer**

Turning existing benefits
into **Engagement**. Drive
Revenues.

Publish, Test, and Connect to Benefits



PUBLISH

Publish articles in entertainment, travel, and gardening

MEASURE

Track clicks and time spent to validate audience interest

CONNECT

Map content to existing benefits

PRIORITIZE

Use performance data to prioritize which benefits to promote first

Retirement is *not* the end of living



Explore more



Enjoy more



Live more

It's a new chapter. Let's *live it fully*.



Q & A

Our Recommendations

 Entertainment

Broaden culture coverage beyond age-labeled content to reflect diverse interest

 Travel

Focus on experiences to inspire and engage.

 Gardening

Position as a lifestyle and wellness category that nurtures mind, body, and home.

Next Steps

01

Publish articles in entertainment, travel, and gardening

02

Track clicks and time spent to validate audience interest

03

Map to existing benefits — hotel discounts, movie tickets, gardening classes

04

Use performance data to prioritize which benefits to promote first

Appendix: Technical Details

- Google Trends data used as proxy for public interest (based on user search/click volume)
- NYT articles matched to trending keywords within the same date window (Mar 3 – Apr 10, 2026)
- Articles classified as Trending if keyword index score exceeded threshold; otherwise Non-Trending
- Date alignment: coalesced date strategy — preferred 'date' column, fell back to 'last_modified' for AARP articles
- Non-Negative Matrix Factorization (NMF) with TF-IDF vectorization
- BERTopic trained on AARP + NYT corpus , producing 78 topics
- Facebook articles classified via .transform() for comparability.